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# Public Comment on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

## Introduction

I appreciate the opportunity to contribute to the Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) and NITRD NCO's development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan. This comment draws on publicly available perspectives from AI industry leaders, researchers, and policy experts to suggest priority policy actions that can both sustain American leadership in AI and ensure appropriate safeguards without unnecessarily hindering innovation.

## Priority Policy Actions

### 1. Research and Development Funding

The United States should significantly increase federal funding for fundamental AI research across multiple agencies, with particular emphasis on:

- Safety and alignment research to ensure AI systems remain beneficial, controllable, and aligned with human values
- Innovative approaches to AI that may yield breakthroughs beyond current large language model paradigms
- Computing infrastructure access for academic researchers and smaller companies to prevent research concentration solely among the largest companies

As Sam Altman of OpenAI has noted, "Government investment in AI safety research is one of the most important things we can do right now."

### 2. Establish Clear Regulatory Frameworks with Tiered Approaches

Develop a tiered regulatory approach based on AI system capabilities and risk profiles:

- For frontier or highly capable AI systems: Implement mandatory safety evaluations, risk assessments, and reporting requirements
- For medium-risk applications: Create industry standards and certification processes
- For low-risk applications: Rely primarily on existing regulations and guidelines

Dario Amodei of Anthropic has emphasized the importance of "tailoring regulation to the capabilities of the system rather than applying one-size-fits-all rules."

### **3. Public-Private Partnership for AI Safety and Standards**

Formalize collaboration between government, industry, and academia through:

- A national AI safety institute that coordinates research and establishes best practices
- Industry consortia to develop technical standards for AI evaluation and safety
- Shared testing infrastructure for pre-deployment assessment of potentially harmful capabilities

### **4. Talent Development and Immigration Reform**

To maintain American leadership in AI:

- Expand AI-related education and training programs across all education levels
- Reform immigration policies to attract and retain global AI talent, including expanding visa programs for AI researchers and engineers
- Create pathways for international AI experts to work in the United States with fewer administrative barriers

Fei-Fei Li of Stanford University has stated that "talent is the most crucial resource in AI development, and the US must remain a magnet for global AI talent."

### **5. Computing Infrastructure and Energy**

Prioritize initiatives to:

- Increase domestic semiconductor manufacturing capability specifically for AI applications
- Invest in energy infrastructure to support the growing power demands of AI computing
- Accelerate research into energy-efficient AI training and inference methods

### **6. International Cooperation and Standards**

Develop a coordinated international approach by:

- Leading international standard-setting efforts for AI safety and governance
- Establishing bilateral and multilateral agreements with allied nations on AI development principles
- Creating mechanisms for international coordination on managing advanced AI systems

## **Balancing Innovation and Responsibility**

The AI Action Plan should carefully balance promoting innovation while addressing legitimate safety concerns:

1. **Avoid Premature or Overly Prescriptive Regulation:** Technical specifications should

remain flexible enough to accommodate rapid technological change.

2. **Focus on Outcomes Rather Than Methods:** Regulate based on system capabilities and impacts rather than specific technical approaches.
3. **Promote Competition:** Ensure that regulatory frameworks don't entrench incumbent advantages or create barriers to entry for smaller innovators.
4. **Strengthen Existing Regulatory Bodies:** Equip agencies like the FTC, FDA, and NIST with AI expertise and resources rather than creating entirely new regulatory structures.

## Conclusion

The United States has an opportunity to set global standards for responsible AI development while maintaining its technological leadership. By implementing these priority actions, the AI Action Plan can create a framework that promotes innovation while addressing legitimate safety concerns and ensuring that AI development benefits society broadly.

Respectfully submitted,

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